

BLINKY

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Canvas by Instructure Affiliated AI TA Blinky

Our Challenge

Propose an innovation that allows Dartmouth professors and staff to better **integrate AI** tools into their curriculums in a way that does not replace **student effort**.

Research Stats

43

Dartmouth students surveyed
via a Google Form.

36

Interviews conducted.
Including 3 Dartmouth
Professors.

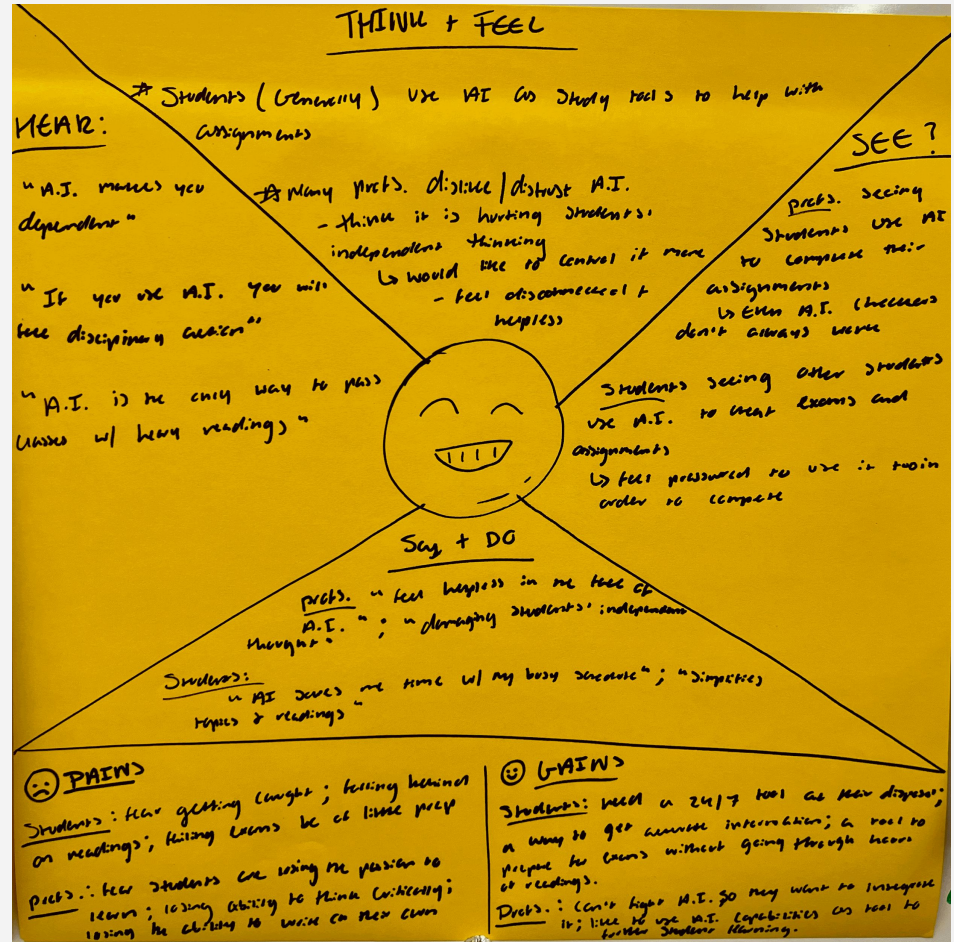
95%

Of interviewed students
utilized AI for coursework.

I find myself using it
mostly for school

Analysis

An empathy map for students and professors



POV

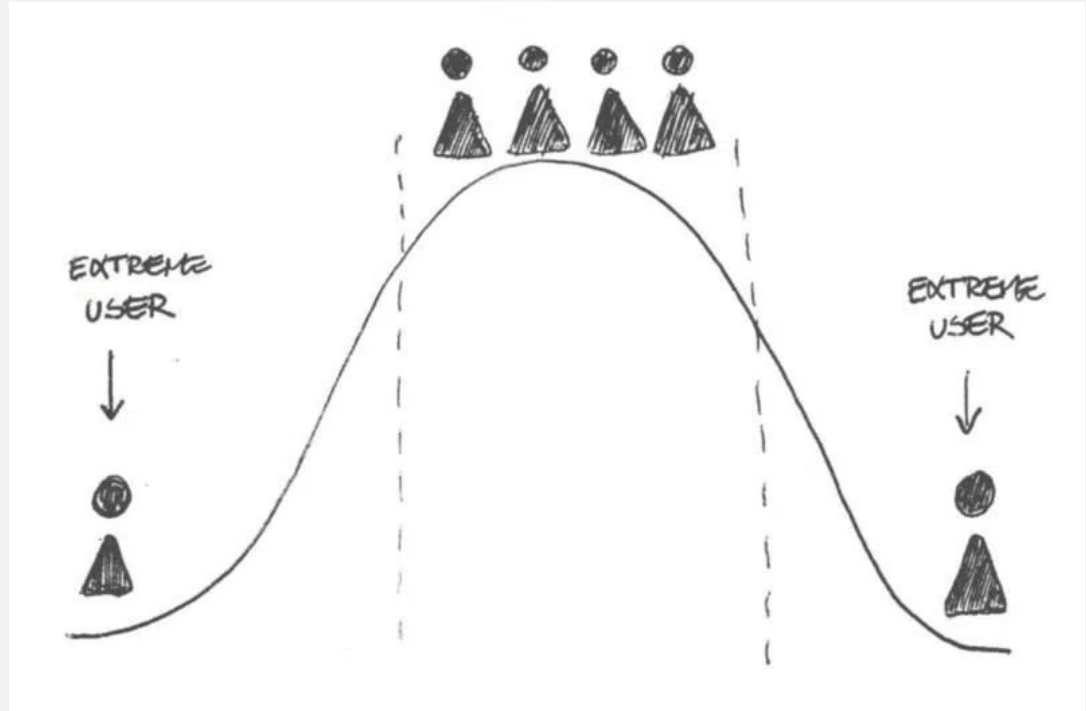
Dartmouth professors need an ethical and structured way to integrate AI into their coursework to encourage student engagement with course material and discourage poor scholarship in order to uphold course integrity.

A busy, highly-motivated Dartmouth student needs to efficiently understand course material, effectively study for exams, and receive personalized feedback in order to succeed in class.

Bright Spot #1

Interviewee AA

- Primes ChatGPT before use through a series of questions/information
- Tells it what sources to use



Bright Spot #2

Harvard CS50's CS50.ai

CS50.ai 🦆 ❤️❤️❤️❤️



ddb

Quack. I am CS50's duck debugger (ddb), an experimental AI for [rubberducking](#). Quack. My replies might not always be accurate, so always think critically and let me know if you think that I've erred. Conversations are logged for debugging's sake. Quack.

you

My code is not working as expected, any ideas?

```
x = input("Give me an integer x: ")
y = input("Give me an integer y: ")
sum = x + y
print("x + y is: " + sum)
```

ddb

It seems like you're trying to add two integers, but the `input()` function in Python returns a string. So, when you try to add `x` and `y`, you're actually concatenating two strings, not adding two integers.

To fix this, you can convert the inputs to integers using the `int()` function like so:

```
x = int(input("Give me an integer x: "))
y = int(input("Give me an integer y: "))
```



Path #1

Create methods that will eliminate all AI use

“When students use AI to brainstorm, they end up having the AI think for them”

“I worked hard to get into Dartmouth to learn. Why would I use ChatGPT to cheat?”

“I’ve definitely become lazier. If I can’t find an answer instantly I’ll ask chat[GPT]”

Path #2

Integrate AI tools into the Dartmouth curriculum in a manner that **both** students and professors approved of.

“I’ve used [chatGPT] to create more exam practice questions for my exams”

“AI can be helpful for revising writing for concision and clarity.”

“ chat[GPT] just helped me find a source for my research paper”

Path #1

Create methods that will eliminate all AI use

AI advising committee for every department

Stronger punishment/policies for students passing AI-generated work as their own.

Training course for incoming students on what AI is, what is useful for, and where it can do damage.

Path #2

Integrate AI tools into the Dartmouth curriculum in a manner that **both** students and professors approved of.

AI attendance tracker

An AI desk in classrooms that displays professors slides and provides AI summaries in real time.

AI student mood tracker; gives professor recommendations on how to adapt teaching style/provide a break depending on mood.

Specifications

- Encourages students to engage with learning material
- Easily accessible to students
- Provide personalized support based on student learning styles
- Prevents students from producing the learning or writing process for them
- Assists studying for exams
- Should take a non-tech-savvy, older professor less than 30 minutes to set up and use

BLINKY – student view



Spring 2025 (A&S)

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- Grades 9
- People
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- Quizzes
- Collaborations
- Chat 10
- Panopticon
- Lucid
- Libra
- Reserve
- BLINKY

MES.01.01-SP25 > BLINKY

can you give me a brief overview of what we did in class today?

Here's a short summary of what we covered in class this week (Week 8):

Tuesday – 1979 Iranian Revolution

- Shah Mohammad Reza Pahlavi's rule and Westernization.
- 1953 coup against Mosaddegh.
- Rise of Ayatollah Khomeini and the White Revolution.
- SAVAK and resistance movements.
- Prelude to the Iran Hostage Crisis.

Thursday – Assassinations & Israeli Politics

- From Anwar Sadat's assassination (1981) to Rabin's assassination (1995).
- Pan-Arabist and religious-nationalist imagery and settlement expansion.
- Local justifications for land claims.
- Assassinations of Israeli leaders and key protests leading to Rabin's death.

Friday X-Hour – Guest Lecture

Ask anything

+

🔊

05/01/25

05/06/25

05/08/25

05/10/25

05/13/25

05/15/25

05/19/25

05/22/25

05/27/25

05/29/25

05/30/25

Ask Blinky for help reviewing class content

Blinky is integrated to the course webpage

Blinky only has access to lectures the student has attended

BLINKY – professor view



MES.01.01-SP25 > PROFESSOR VIEW > BLINKY

Spring 2025 (A&S)

Home

Announcements

Assignments

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Grades 9

People

Files

Syllabus

Quizzes

Collaborations

Chat 10

Panopto Video

Lucid (Whiteboard)

Library

Reserves/Guides

BLINKY



Good day Professor! Here is today's BLINKY report...

Commonly Asked Questions:

1. Who were the SAVAK? [18 asks](#)
2. Who was the Egyptian President during the Iranian Revolution? [6 asks](#)
3. What year did Anwar Sadat get assassinated? [4 asks](#)

[view more...](#)

Student Feedback:

1. Slow down in class. [9 asks](#)
2. Review Iranian Revolution in more depth. [4 asks](#)

[view more...](#)

Settings:

- ☒ Minimize Response Length (<5 Sentences)
- ☐ Web Search
- ☒ File Upload

05/01/25

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05/27/25

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05/30/25

Blinky complies frequently asked questions

Blinky can also collect anonymous student feedback

Professors have control over how Blinky interacts with their students

Next Steps

- Collaboration Mode:
 - Students in the same course may share an AI TA and work together
- Learning Style Adjustment:
 - An assessment given so the AI TA can adjust their feedback to suit the specific students' learning style
- Offline mode:
 - Student has access to a log of their previous chats without internet

Pathway to Solution

1. Observations, Interviews
2. Research analysis, need definition, follow-up interviews
3. Ideation prototype brainstorming
4. Expand on chosen prototype “BLINKY”, feedback interviews
5. Crit Session on Refined Prototype

Key Takeaway

If you can't beat them, **join them.**

Thank You